Dog Knee Brace

Troubleshooting & Fitting Guide

ABOUT THIS BRACE

This is a flexible neoprene support with rigid lateral stabilizers along the side of the leg. It is designed to steady the knee while your dog keeps moving. It is not a rigid immobilizer and will not hold the joint still.

Almost every fitting problem comes down to one thing: **the brace is hanging on the leg instead of being suspended from the body.** The three issues below are ordered by how often they occur.

ISSUE 1

The Brace Slides Down the Leg

This is the most common issue, and it is almost never a defect. A neoprene brace cannot resist gravity by gripping the thigh alone. It has to be held up from above.

HOW TO FIX IT

01 Put On the Belly Anchor Strap — Snug, Not Tight

This is what holds the brace up. The belly strap is the suspension system. Pass it around your dog's torso and fasten it snug but not tight — secure enough to stay in place, loose enough that you can still position the rest of the brace comfortably. For male dogs, cross it diagonally to avoid the genital area. Do not pull it firm yet: tightening it now can pull the rest of the brace off-center.

02 Center the Brace, Then Tighten the Straps

Position the brace so it sits centered over the knee. The top thigh strap sits high on the thigh and stops the brace from rotating. Fasten it firm against the fur, with no

slack. The lower straps are for shaping the fit around the knee — they are not what holds the brace on. Once the brace is in place, go back to the belly strap and pull it firm — firm enough that it does not shift when you tug the brace downward with your hand. If this strap is loose, nothing else you do will keep the brace in place.

03 Check the Tension with the Rotation Test

Try to rotate the brace around the leg by hand. If it turns easily, it is too loose. A correctly fitted brace resists rotation.

04 If It Still Slides, Re-measure

The Zero Gap Rule: wrap a measuring tape around the upper thigh, halfway between the groin and the knee. Pull the tape **snug against the fur — you should not be able to fit any fingers underneath.** A loose measurement is the most common reason a dog ends up in a size too large.

05 Between Two Sizes? Choose the Smaller One

If the measurement falls between two sizes, **choose the smaller one.** A snug fit is what keeps the brace in position. The larger size will have slack from the first day.

ISSUE 2

The Brace Stays On While Walking, but Moves After My Dog Lies Down

This is normal and expected with any flexible brace. When a dog lies down and stands back up, the leg flexes through its full range and the brace can shift.

HOW TO FIX IT

01 Re-check the Belly Strap After Rest Periods

It is the strap most likely to have loosened. A quick tug to confirm tension takes a few seconds.

02 Fit the Brace While Your Dog Is Standing

Not while your dog is lying down. A brace fitted on a resting dog will be loose once the dog stands.

03 Take the Brace Off for Naps and Overnight

It is made for active periods. Leaving it on during long rest both loosens it and gives your dog no break from the pressure.

ISSUE 3

The Brace Reaches the Ankle or Scrapes the Floor

The rigid stabilizers run along the side of the leg. If they reach the ankle or touch the floor when your dog stands, your dog's leg is shorter than the minimum this brace needs, and the brace will interfere with walking.

WHAT TO DO

This One Cannot Be Fixed by Adjustment

Measure the groin-to-floor height with your dog standing, and compare it to the minimum for the size you bought:

Size	Min. groin-to-floor height
S	10"
M	11"

Size	Min. groin-to-floor height
L	13.5"

If your dog is below the minimum for its size, the brace cannot be worn safely. Contact us and we will process a return.

Not suitable for Corgis, Dachshunds, Basset Hounds or toy breeds — these typically fall below the minimum leg length.

QUICK CHECKLIST

Before You Decide It Does Not Work

- ☐ Belly anchor strap pulled firm, does not shift when you tug the brace down
- ☐ Top thigh strap firm against the fur, no slack
- ☐ Brace does not rotate around the leg when you try to turn it by hand
- ☐ Fitted while the dog was standing
- ☐ Thigh measured snug against the fur, no fingers under the tape
- ☐ Stabilizers clear the floor when the dog stands

If all six are checked and the brace still does not stay in place, **contact us.**

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Comfort with Every Step